

Lightning.ai Account - Setup Instructions

1. Set up Lightning.ai Account

- Go to: <https://lightning.ai/pricing/>
- Click on **Get started free**
- Select **Email** (first option), then type in your **university email address**
- You will then receive an email to confirm your email address. Click on the **Log in** button in that email, which will take you back to their website. Then click **Next**
- On the next page (**How do you want to code:**), click on **Browser**, and click **Next**
- On the following page (**What machine do you want to use:**), click on **CPU** (top left option), and click **Next**
- On the next page, enter your mobile phone number (this is being used for two-factor authentication), and click on **Request verification code**
- You will be sent a 6-digit code by text message (SMS). Enter this code where it says **Enter verification code**. Then click **Verify**
- When you see **Congratulations, your account is verified!**: Click **Next**
- Then you see **Invite members (optional)**: Click **Next**
- For **Select Git integration:**: Choose **Connect later** (right-hand option), and click **Next**, then click **Start building!**
- When you see **Welcome to your first Studio ...**: Click **Next**
- When you see **You are on the Free tier ...**: Click **I understand**.
- You are now in the first **Studio** created on Lightning.ai. On the right-hand side, Lightning.ai's *native credit-consuming AI copilot service* is enabled by default. You can try if you like it. (Clicking the **AI copilot** button near the top right part of the Studio toggles off the services.)
- Alternatively, you can follow the instructions below to enable and use the **GitHub Copilot** chat interface

(Note: Use of GitHub Copilot on Lightning.ai will **consume your GitHub credit allowance**, not the credit allowance provided by Lightning.ai.)

2. Enable GitHub Copilot on Lightning.ai

- In a Lightning.ai Studio, log into your GitHub account using the **‘human head’ credentials button** in the lower left corner
 - This should be sufficient to enable the GitHub Copilot chat interface in the right-hand side panel
- Once logged in, a window will pop up asking for the permission as follows:

The extension ‘GitHub Copilot Chat’ wants to sign in using GitHub. To show you more relevant Copilot Chat results, we need permission to read the contents of your repository on GitHub.

- Click the **Allow** button. Then follow the additional instructions on screen to complete the process
- When completed, click the **Toggle Secondary Side Bar** button in the upper right corner to toggle on the panel with the GitHub Copilot chat interface.

- If the GitHub Copilot chat interface does not already allow you to select the **Mode** (Ask/Plan/Agent) from a drop-down menu, enter a trivial question like ‘**hi there**’
 - This should initialize the default AI model and give you a reply like ‘*What can I help you today?*’. The Mode selector should then be available for selection
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(Note: Teamspace is now called **Organization**)

3. Create a Studio in a Teamspace

- Each Studio must belong to a Teamspace, where users can be invited to collaborate on Studios in the Teamspace.
 - Even for an individual user, one must select an existing/set up a new Teamspace before a Studio can be created in it
 - If you are currently inside a Studio, you can shut it down first, which will take you to the **Dashboard** page showing all your Teamspaces and the Studios in each Teamspace
 - To shut down a Studio when you are in it, click the **CPU button** (or **T4 button**) near the top right corner of the Studio, followed by clicking the green **Power** button on the top line of the pop-up window
 - Then click **Yes, sleep** in the next window
 - The first time you shut down your first Studio, you will see a pop-up window **This is your Lightning teamspace**. Click **CLOSE** in the upper left corner to close it. This will take you to the Dashboard page
 - To create a new Teamspace, click the ‘**+** **button**’ in the lower left corner of the page, followed by clicking the **Next** button to accept the **Default** choice in the pop-up window
 - In the next window, give a **name** to the new Teamspace to be created, followed by clicking the **Create** button
 - On the next page, click the ‘**+ New Studio**’ button to create a new Studio in the newly created Teamspace.
 - Select, for example, **Python** in the pop-up window and leave the machine type unchanged (i.e., **Default (CPU)**)
 - Then click the **Start** button. This will complete the steps to create the new Studio
 - Be patient to wait until the **progress bar** near the top of the newly created Studio to reach **100%** before doing anything in the Studio
 - Otherwise, any interruption runs the risk of causing defects in the Studio and unexpected behaviors.
 - The (VS Code) interface of a Lightning.ai **Studio** is highly similar to the (VS Code) interface of a **GitHub Cospace**.
 - Additionally, you can switch to Lightning.ai’s **JupyterLab** interface by clicking the respective button on the vertical menu bar at the right edge of the Studio.
 - A Studio will get into **Auto sleep after 10 mins of inactivity**, or **after being used continuously for 4 hours**.
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(Note: Below is for use *during the Workshop*)

4. Clone a Studio shared through a Studio template

- Click the link **BigramCloud_GPUorCPU** provided in the Workshop slides, which will take you to a page with a **Clone button**.
 - Click the button to clone the Studio to your Lightning.ai account.
- In the pop-up window, ***select the Teamspace*** where you would like to clone the Studio, followed by clicking **Open**.
- Because the default machine of the shared Studio is **T4**, you must have credits in the selected Teamspace (or transfer some into it) before the shared Studio can be cloned there.
 - Click the **Transfer credits** link in the pop-up window to transfer in credits (if there is no credit in the chosen Teamspace). Then click the **Confirm** button to confirm the transfer.
- Click **Open** to open the cloned Studio.
 - If the value of the transferred-in credits is regarded low, you will see a pop-up window to suggest **Add credits**. You can remove the window by clicking the **'x' button**.